



The Explosive Atmosphere Safety Specialist
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The ExVeritas Group provides Product Certification, Management System Certification, CompEx Certification and Site Safety Services.

ExVeritas are a UK Government Appointed Body for UKCA 'Ex', an ATEX Notified Body and an IECEx Certification Body and Test Laboratory

Zones		
gases	dusts	Zone- A place in which an explosive atmosphere is...
0	20	continually present
1	21	likely to occur in normal operation occasionally
2	22	not likely to occur in normal operation and only for very short durations

Equipment Ambient Temperature: Explosion protected (Ex) equipment shall only be used in the following temperature range unless otherwise stated on the equipment. -20°C to +40°C

ATEX Marking- 2014/34/EU (was 94/9/EC)				
Equipment Group	Category	Environment	Zone of use	
I	M1	Methane and Coal Dust	N/A	
I	M2		N/A	
II	1	Gas, Vapour Mists and Dusts	0/20	
II	2		1/21	
II	3		2/22	

Temperature Class	
T-Class	Maximum Surface Temperature in °C
T1	450
T2	300
T3	200
T4	135
T5	100
T6	85

Groups (IEC)			
Group	Environment	Location	Typical Substance
I	Gas/Dust	Coal Mining	Methane (Fire Damp)
IIA	Gases, Vapours and mists	Surface and other mines	Methane, Propane etc.
IIB			Ethylene
IIC			Hydrogen, Acetylene etc.
IIIA	Combustible Dust	Surface	Combustible flying's
IIIB			Non-conductive
IIIC			Conductive

Topic	IEC (CENELEC) Standard
Area Classification- Gases, Vapours and Mists	IEC (EN) 60079-10-1
Area Classification- Combustible Dusts	IEC (EN) 60079-10-2
Electrical Equipment Installation	IEC (EN) 60079-14
Electrical Equipment Inspection and maintenance	IEC (EN) 60079-17
Electrical Equipment Repair and Overhaul	IEC (EN) 60079-19
Material Characteristics of Gases and Vapours	ISO/IEC 80079-20-1
Material Characteristics of Combustible Dusts	ISO/IEC 80079-20-2

International Protection IEC 60529:1992 + A2:2013

1st Figure Protection against Solids		
IP	Test	Comment
0	None	No protection
1		Protected against solid bodies greater than 50mm diameter. (e.g. accidental contact with the hand)
2		Protected against solid bodies greater than 12.5mm diameter. (e.g. finger)
3		Protected against solid bodies greater than 2.5mm diameter (e.g. tools, wires)
4		Protected against solid bodies greater than 1.0mm diameter (e.g. thin tools and fine wire)
5		Protected against dust (no harmful deposit) Dust Proof
6		Completely protected against dusts Dust Tight

2nd Figure Protection against Water		
IP	Test	Comment
0	None	No protection
1		Protected against vertically falling drops of water (condensation)
2		Protected against drops of water falling up to 15° from the vertical
3		Protected against water sprayed up to 60° from the vertical
4		Protected against splashing water from all directions
5		Protected against jets of water from all directions
6		Protected against powerful jets of water from all directions
7		Protected against the effects of temporary immersion in water
8		Protected against the continuous effects of immersion in water having regard to specific conditions
9		Protected against high pressure and temperature water jets

IEC (International Electrotechnical Commission) Publication IEC 60529 Classification of Degrees of Protection Provided by Enclosures provides a system for specifying the enclosures of equipment on the basis of the degree of protection provided by the enclosure.

Zones/ATEX Categories/EPL's

Zone	ATEX Categories (Levels of Protection) Group II (Typical)	Equipment Protection Levels
0	1G	Ga
1	2G	Gb
2	3G	Gc
20	1D	Da
21	2D	Db
22	3D	Dc

Typical Equipment Marking: IEC Marking

Ex	db	IIC	T*	Gb	Db	+	/
Explosive Atmosphere	Concept letter + EPL	IEC Equipment group Gas (IIA, IIB or IIC) or Combustible Dusts IIIA, IIIB or IIIC	Temperature Class *For dust equipment this is the surface temperature and would be in °C	Environment		IEC 60079-26	
				Gas EPL	Dust EPL	Two concepts together allowed in a higher EPL location	Equipment in a boundary wall

Cable Gland, adapters and accessories, Selection Chart IEC 60079-14:2013 Table 10

Protection Technique	Glands, adapters and blanking elements		
Gases and Vapours (Group II)			
	Ex d	Ex e	Ex n
Ex d	✓		
Ex e	✓	✓	
Ex i and nL	✓	✓	
Ex n except nL		✓	✓
Ex p	✓	✓	
			✓ (Gc only)
Combustible Dust (Group III)			
		Ex t	
Ex t		✓	
Ex p		✓	
Ex i		✓	

NB. If only one intrinsically safe circuit is applied then there are no specified requirements for cable glands. IEC 60079-14:2013 table 10. To meet IP requirements it may be necessary to use an IP washer or thread sealant between the entry device and the enclosure.

Minimum IP Rating for equipment used in Group III Hazardous locations

Level of Protection	Group IIIC	Group IIIB	Group IIIA
ta	IP6X	IP6X	IP6X
tb	IP6X	IP6X	IP5X
tc	IP6X	IP5X	IP5X

IP seal washers may be used on parallel threads. If no IP seal washer is used then thread engagement shall be five full threads

Pressurized Enclosures used in Group II Hazardous locations. Determination of type of protection (no internal release)			
EPL	ATEX Category	Enclosure contains equipment not meeting "Gc" requirements	Enclosure contains equipment meeting "Gc" requirements
Gb	2G	Type "pxb"	Type "pyb"
Gc	3G	Type "pxb" or "pxc"	Type "pyb" no pressurization"

IEC 60079-2 require that equipment of type of protection "py" will only contain equipment of type of protection "d", "e", "f", "m", "nA", "nC", "o" or "q"

Data for Flammable Gases and Vapours (ISO/IEC 80079-20-1:2017)

Listed below are the flammability values for a number of common gases and vapours used in industry. There are more than 300 gases and vapours. Refer to ISO/IEC 80079-20-1:2017 for further details.

CAS No	Substance	Density relative to air (Air =1)	Flash point °C	Melting Point °C	Boiling Point °C	Flammable Limits Volume %		Ignition Temperature °C	Maximum Experimental Safe Gap (MESG) mm	Temperature Class	Group	Minimum Ignition Current Ratio
74-86-2	Acetylene	0.90	gas			2.3	100	305	0.37	T2	IIC	0.28
106-97-8	Butane	2.05	gas	-138	-1	1.4	9.3	372	0.98	T2	IIA	0.94
75-15-0	Carbon Disulphide	2.64	-30	-112	46	0.6	60.0	90	0.34	T6	IIC	0.39
142-96-1	Dibutyl Ether	4.48	25	-95	141	8.5	48	175	0.86	T4	IIB	
64-17-5	Ethanol	1.59	12	-114	78	3.1	19.0/27.7	400	0.89	T2	IIB	0.88
141-78-6	Ethyl Acetate	3.04	-	-83	77	2.0	12.8	470	0.99	T1	IIA	
74-85-1	Ethylene	0.97	gas	-169	-104	2.3	36.0	440	0.65	T2	IIB	0.53
50-00-0	Formaldehyde	1.03	60	-92	-6	7.0	73.0	424	0.57	T2	IIB	
142-82-5	Heptane	3.46	-7	-91	98	0.85	6.7	204	0.91	T3	IIA	0.88
1333-74-0	Hydrogen	0.07	gas	-259	-253	4.0	77.0	560	0.29	T1	IIC	0.25
8008-20-6	Kerosene		38 to 72°			0.70	5.0	210		T3	IIA	
74-82-8	Methane (Firedamp)	0.55	gas			4.4	17.0	595	1.14	T1	I	
74-82-8	Methane		gas	-182	-162	4.4	17.0	600	1.12	T1	IIA	1.00
111-65-9	Octane	3.93	13	-57	126	0.80	6.5	208	0.94	T3	IIA	
8006-61-9	Petrol(Gasoline)	3.0	-46			1.4	7.6	280		T3		
74-98-6	Propane	1.56	gas	-188	-42	1.7	10.9	450	0.92	T2	IIA	0.82
108-88-3	Toluene	3.2	4	-95	111	1.10	7.8	530	1.06	T1	IIA	
8006-64-2	Turpentine		35	-50 to -60°	154 to 170°	0.80		253		T3	IIA	
95-47-6	Xylene	3.66	30			1.0	7.6	470	1.09	T1	IIA	

Marking Explained

Example Marking Gas				Example Marking Dust			
Group (Surface)	Gas	Protection Concept(s)	Equipment Protection Level (EPL)	Group (Surface)	Dust Protection Concept(s)	Equipment Protection Level (EPL)	
Ex	II 2 G	Ex db	IIB T4 Gb Tamb -20°C to +55°C	Ex	II 2 D	Ex tb	IIIB T120°C Db
	ATEX Category	Gas Sub-Group	Temperature Classification		Dust	Dust Sub-Group	Temperature

For the latest information, the appropriate IEC and European standards on explosive atmospheres should be referenced. If further information is required on any aspects of explosive atmospheres and/or equipment used in these areas. Please contact The Exveritas Group

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Relationship between Gas/Vapour or Dust and Equipment Group

Location gas/vapour or dust subgroup	Permitted equipment group
IIA	II, IIA, IIB or IIC
IIB	II, IIB or IIC
IIC	II or IIC
IIIA	IIIA, IIIB or IIIC
IIIB	IIIB or IIIC
IIIC	IIIC

Equipment Selection by ATEX Category

Equipment Category	Hazardous Area Classification (Zones)		
	0/20	1/21	2/22
1	✓	✓	✓
2	✗	✓	✓
3	✗	✗	✓

Ex d Flange equipment Obstruction Distances

Location Gas Group	Permitted Distance mm
IIA	10
IIB	30
IIC	40

Equipment Selection by Group

Equipment Group	Gas Area (Location)		
	IIC	IIB	IIA
IIC	✓	✓	✓
IIB	✗	✓	✓
IIA	✗	✗	✓
Dust Area (Location)			
Equipment Group	IIIC	IIIB	IIIA
	IIIC	IIIB	IIIA
IIIC	✓	✓	✓
IIIB	✗	✓	✓
IIIA	✗	✗	✓

Equipment Selection by Temperature Class

Equipment Class	Area						
	T6	T5	T4	T3	T2	T1	
T6	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
T5	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	✓	
T4	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	✓	
T3	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	✓	
T2	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	✓	
T1	✗	✗	✗	✗	✗	✓	

Quality Management System Certification

ExVeritas offer the following Quality Management Systems Certification, Ex Quality Assurance Notifications and Ex Quality Assessment Reports - either individually or as one combined audit

Scheme	Standard / Directive	Accreditation	Required for:
ISO 9001 Quality Management Systems Certification	ISO 9001	UKAS Accredited (IAF)	General interational QMS acceptance
UKCA Quality Assurance Notifications (UK QAN)	UKSI 2016:1107 Part 2 to 5. ISO/IEC 80079-34	UKAS Accredited Government Approved Body	Required for UKEx Product Certification for certain types of equipment (UKCA marking)
ATEX Quality Assurance Notifications (ATEX QAN)	ATEX Directive 2014/34/EU Annex IV to VII. ISO/IEC 80079-34	DANAK Accredited EU Notified Body	Required for ATEX Product Certification for certain types of equipment (CE marking)
IECEX Certification Body - Quality Assessment Reports (QAR)	ISO/IEC 80079-34	IECEX Certification Body	Required for IECEX Product Certification for all types of equipment
IECEX Certified Service Facility - Certificates of Conformity (CoC)	IEC 60079-19	IECEX Certification Body	Required for IECEX Certified Service Facilities
IECEX Certified Service Facility - Facility Assessment Reports (FAR)	IEC 60079-19	IECEX Certification Body	Required for IECEX Certified Service Facilities

Training and CompEx Certification

ExVeritas CompEx Courses			
Course	Description	Duration	Certification
Foundation	An introductory level, theory only course designed to provide an overview into potentially explosive environments. IEC and NEC 500/505 versions available	2 Days	Exam and Certificate
ExF			Awareness Certificate
Foundation Plus	The foundation course with a day of practical instruction and installation exercises and assessment. IEC and NEC 500/505 versions available	3 Days	Exam with some practical assessment and Certificate
ExF+			Awareness Certificate
Gas and vapours	For practicing electrical and instrument operatives working in potentially explosive environments	5 Days	Theory and Practical Exams
Ex01 – Ex04	3 day EX R Refresher Course also available (before 5 years)		Accredited Core Competence Certification
Dust	For practicing electrical or instrumentation technicians who work in dust potentially explosive environments	3 Days	Theory and Practical Exams
Ex05 – Ex06			Accredited Core Competence Certification
Mechanical	For mechanical operatives working in hazardous locations where gases, vapours or dusts can form explosive atmospheres.	3 Days	Theory and Practical Exams
Ex11			Accredited Core Competence Certification
Application Design Engineer	For application design engineers who specify electrical equipment potentially explosive environments	5 Days	Theory Exams
Ex12			Accredited Core Competence Certification
Responsible Person	For persons in senior supervisory roles, such as those responsible for managing staff, processes and procedures relating to potentially explosive environments	4 days	Theory Exams
Ex14			Accredited Core Competence Certification

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